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removal of deforming force is called the elastic limit.

If the deforming force exceeds the elastic limit, the body acquires a permanent deformation. For example, rubber band loses its elasticity if pulled apart too much. It changes its size and becomes misfit to be used again.

7.2.3 Hooke's law and its experimental verification

Hooke's law is for a small deformation, when the stress and strain are proportional to each other. It can be verified in a simple way by stretching a thin straight wire (stretches like spring) of length L and uniform cross-sectional area A suspended from a fixed point O. A pan and a pointer are attached at the free end of the wire as shown in Figure 7.7 (a). The extension produced on the wire is measured using a vernier scale arrangement. The experiment shows that for a given load, the corresponding stretching force is F and the elongation produced on the wire is ΔL. It is directly proportional to the original length L and inversely proportional to the area of cross section A. A graph is plotted using F on the X- axis and ΔL on the Y- axis. This graph is a straight line passing through the origin as shown in Figure 7.7 (b).

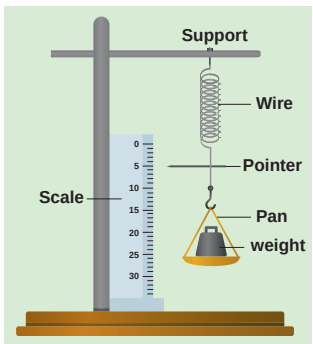


Figure 7.7 (a) Experimental verification of Hooke's law

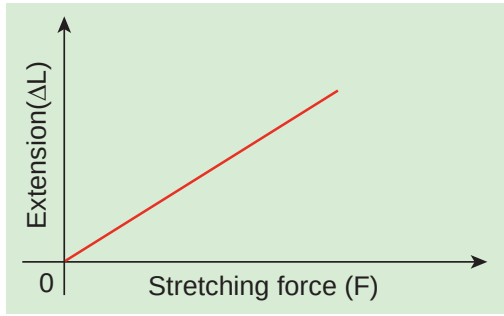


Figure 7.7 (b) Variation of ΔL with F

Therefore,

$$\Delta L = (\text{slope})F$$

Multiplying and dividing by volume,

$$V = A\,L,$$

$$F\ (\text{slope}) = \frac{AL}{AL}\Delta L$$

Rearranging, we get

$$\frac{F}{A} = \left(\frac{L}{A(slope)}\right)\frac{\Delta L}{L}$$

Therefore, $\frac{F}{A} \propto \left(\frac{\Delta L}{L}\right)$

Comparing with equation (7.1) and equation (7.2), we get equation (7.5) as

$$\sigma \propto \varepsilon$$

i.e., the stress is proportional to the strain in the elastic limit.

Stress – Strain profile curve:

The stress versus strain profile is a plot in which stress and strain are noted for each load and a graph is drawn taking strain along the X-axis and stress along the Y-axis. The elastic characteristics of the materials can be analyzed from the stress-strain profile.

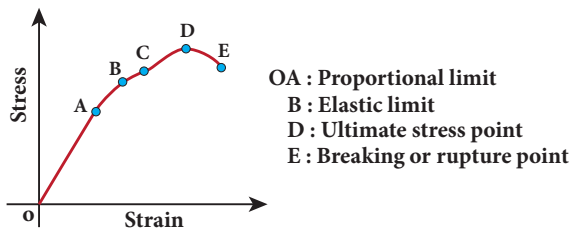


Figure 7.8 Stress-Strain profile